Report on Tata Group and Its Growth Strategies

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Executive Summary

Jamsetji Tata founded the Tata Group in 1868, at the start the company was operational domestically and was mainly focussed on organic growth. The group global expansion started in 2000 by acquiring some of the key companies, and currently working in more than 100 countries (Tata, 2015 a). Presently the group contains more than 100 independent firms. The companies with substantial scale comprise Tata Motors, Tata Steel, Tata Power, Tata Consultancy Services, Tata Global Beverages, Tata Chemicals, Tata Teleservices, Tata Communications, Indian Hotels and Titan. In 2014/15, the revenue of the group was $108.78 billion (Tata, 2015 a).

At the initial stage, Tata Group growth was mainly organic because of industrial development in India and international alliances were not conducive enough (Faheem, 2012). The main reasons behind Tata development were innovations, up-gradation in technology and new product development. The first internally developed car called Indica was introduced in 1998 and the world cheapest car was unveiled in 2008 called Nano; the car was developed through several innovations and expertise to make the costs very low (Faheem, 2012).

The main transformation of the group happened under Ratan Tata who became the chairman of Tata Group in 1991, he is known as the most powerful businessman in India and among the most influential in the world (Jamshedpur, 2011). He expanded the business globally, under him Tata business restructured and redefined. He created a group of executives to improve integration between the companies and to review group monthly operations he developed corporative centre (Faheem, 2012). These measures helped improve company productivity significantly. The major step in inorganic growth happened when Tata tea acquired Tetley a UK based company in 2000 (Faheem, 2012). And later on the acquisition rally expanded and they acquired Corus in 2007 and in 2008 Jaguar and Land Rover of UK. Although, the acquisitions helped the company growth but it raised the challenges of companies' integration and management (Faheem, 2012).

Since 2000 the company has invested hugely on inorganic growth. Although, historically mergers and acquisitions deals had negative results (Schraeder and Dennis, 2003), but Tata was successful in most cases. They were able to successfully integrate between companies and create a culturally suitable environment for their employees. In some cases, experts have strongly criticized Tata's acquisition moves specially JLR and Corus acquisition which happened during global economic crises in 2007-8 but now these deals are among the key revenue generators in the group and were gambles which paid off (Philip and Joshi, 2014). In addition, inorganic growth not only provided financial benefits to the group but turned out to be the key in terms of intangible benefits such as modern technology and human resources (Gribben, 2013).

Global presence in diverse industries and access to advanced technology and key markets are signs of more success and profitability for Tata Group going forward. They need to focus more on integration among the companies as it is challenging managing a vast group of 100 companies. Moving ahead, Tata firms are developing global businesses which want to differentiate themselves via innovation, customer centricity, trustworthiness, values-driven and

entrepreneurship industry operations, while matching the benefits of various shareholders, civil society, and employees. (Tata, 2015 a)

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1. Introduction

This report is focused on the Tata Group's growth strategies. In addition, the report comments on Tata organic and inorganic growth strategies, management of strategic change, innovation strategies, and assessment of frim risk management. The report has covered the most updated situation of Tata Group as well. The report not only covers Tata progress and strategies but it also compares the literature view with the firm implementation. It further analyses a case study written by Hadiya Faheem in 2012.

The report starts by Tata Group background and then it comments on Tata organic growth followed by inorganic growth strategies. After discussing the firm both growth strategies the report then focuses on how the firm managed strategic change. Later on, the Tata Group innovation strategy and risk management have been discussed. The report ends with a conclusion.

2. Background

Jamsetje Tata founded Tata Group in 1868. The firm headquarter is in India and is an international enterprise with a presence in over a hundred countries. Within the group, more than 100 independent companies are operating. Under the supervision and guidance of shareholders and its own board of directors, the companies are operating independently. The total revenue of the group was 108.78 billion USD in 2014-15, with having more than 600,000 employees. The main companies in the board are Tata Motor, Tata Consultancy, Tata Steel, Tata Power, Tata Beverages, Indian Hotels and Tata Communications (Tata, 2015 a). Among these Tata Communication is world number one voice wholesale provider, Tata Motors is in world top ten motor manufacturer lists, Tata steel is world #11 in the steel industry and Tata Consultancy is second in the world in IT services (Tata, 2015 b).

3. Tata Group organic growth

Organic growth is a low-risk strategy compared to inorganic one, and it is considered time-consuming and a step by step progress but organically growing businesses usually face less integration and cultural challenges than inorganic ones (Kuntz, 2014). This type of growth is developed mostly by company strengths and sales improvement and companies can survive via innovation, new product development, and focusing on various emerging markets (IMI, 2015).

At initial years Tata growth strategy was organic, focused mainly on technology and products quality improvement (Faheem, 2012). During this period the company created different indigenous industries like steel, hospitality, airline, consultancy, and power. Tata Group differentiates themselves via low cost and innovations, some of the innovation in Tata steel happened through technological capabilities like efficient gas generators, corrosion resisted steel production and emulsion atomizers(Faheem, 2012). In most cases, Tata organic growth was based on customer demands in India, such as Tata Consultancy Services Ltd (TCS) development

of new softwares according to domestic market demand like stock exchange, custody, depository, and brokerage products. For products improvement, the company founded a research centre called Tata Research and Design and Development Centre TRDDC (Faheem, 2012).

Tata motor also followed the organic growth strategy and produced a car called Idica in 1998, which became one of the most selling cars in India, later on they produced several other models in India like Idiva, Sumo, MPV and the most famous one the world cheapest car called Nano, priced 2500 USD (Faheem, 2012)

4. Tata Group Strategies for Inorganic Growth

Global studies on mergers and acquisition indicate that it helps firms achieve higher valuation by acquiring global targets in related businesses (Marcelo et al, 2008). Through this strategy, new knowledge and skills become available, immediate asset and market share increases, and capital and new markets access become easier but it increases integration and organizational cultural handling challenges as well (Kuntz, 2014). Schraeder and Dennis (2003) identified organizational culture as a potential success catalyst in merger and acquisition (M&A) deals.

Based on Faheem (2012) Ratan Tata believed that involvement in the global market will make their business efficient and competitive. The RS 5 billion revenue loss of Tata motors in 2000 had more influence on Tata decision to enter globally, as reliance on the single economy was risky in case of environmental changes. They believed that global involvement will minimize the risks as if one economy downs they might have other up (Faheem, 2012)

To mitigate the risk of single market reliance Tata started to focus on inorganic growth (Faheem, 2012). The first stint of inorganic growth happened when Ratan Tata acquired Tetley a UK based Tea Company in 2000 by 432 million USD. Tetley was three times bigger than Tata tea, although the risk was high but this acquisition provided Tata tea with an international brand (Faheem, 2012). TCS also followed the route of M&A and started a partnership with global IT companies. TCS established development centres across the world for instance in Australia, USA, UK, China, Japan, and Hungry. These centres helped them to be connected with IT development across the globe and strengthen their presence in the global market (Faheem, 2012). In 2004 Tata Group acquired US-based Tyco Company who owned 60,000 KM long undersea cables, which made Tata the largest international phone call and data carrier in the world (Tata, 2015 d).

Date	Tata Com	Acquired Company	Country	Stake Acquired
2015				
March	Tata Power	Itezhi Tezhi Power Corporation (ITPC)	Zambia	50 per cent
February	Tata Business Support Services	e-Nxt Financials (e-Nxt)	India	
2014				
December	Tata Power	Energy Projects Limited (IEPL)	India	100 per cent
May	Tata Global Beverages	Earth Rules (acquired by Bronski Eleven, a TGB subsidiary)	Australia	100 per cent

Table No.1 indicates Tata recent acquisition, (Tata, 2015 c)

In 2004 Daewo acquisition helped Tata to enter South East Asian, Korea, and China's motors market which was a key step toward Tata motors globalization. In 2005 they signed a deal with Thailand Rung Car PLC, which provide them access to the world second largest utility manufacturing (Pick-up trucks) market. The JV with Marcopolo the world biggest bus manufacturer helped Tata to develop the largest bus manufacturing factory in India (Faheem, 2012). In same year Tata started an alliance with Fiat which enabled Tata to have access to diverse technology in automobile field. By acquiring Jaguar Land Rover Tata has built a strong case in the motor world and became one of the major motor players in the global market (Tata, 2015 c).

Tata Steel has also focused on acquisition; in 2005 they acquired Nat-Steel a Singapore based company for 486.4 million USD. Nat has mills in China, Philippines, Australia, Vietnam, and Thailand, which helped Tata to globalize its steel business. In 2007 Tata acquired Corus Group for 13.7 billion USD, on that time this deal made Tata the 5th largest steel company in the world, currently 11th based on World steel association (2015). On other side, Tata expanded hotel business by acquiring Pierre, Ritz Carlton, Camden Place and Boston (Faheem, 2012)

Figure No.1, Tata Group revenue per years (Tata, 2015 b)

As figure No1 indicates Tata significant exponential revenue increase happened in 2006-8 period and based on Tata acquisition and merger list between 2006 and 2008 they have acquired 28 companies globally in different industries, surprisingly during that time the world market was suffering from financial crises. The analysis of Tata Group acquisition list (Tata, 2015 c) indicates that Tata's most acquisitions are strategically important and most of them are big names in key industries such as JLR, Corus, and others, which provided them access to key markets in different geographies, resources and modern technology.

5. Tata Group Management of Strategic Change

At the start, Tata strategy was focused on organic growth, and they were distinguished themselves by quality, low price and innovation and their presence were mostly in Indian market (Faheem, 2012). The influential factor in strategic change was the loss of revenue of Tata Motor and others business due to the downturn of the economy, and soon after the losses, Tata started focussing on global markets. The globalization was such fast that in 2014 Tata Group's 67.5% of revenue was from global markets mainly through inorganic growth, which counted around USD 73.4 Billion with UK and USA among the key creators of revenue (Tata, 2015 f).

Both organic and organic growth played a key role in Tata success, for instance, Tata Motor was an award winner for its innovative car Nano which indicates their organic success as well as in organic growth acquisition of Corus provided Tata steel with a strong presence in the global steel industry, especially in Europe, (Faheem 2012). M&A is now considered as an important means

for implementation of resource reallocation and corporate strategies in the global business (Gupta and Roos 2001). Tata has also changed the focus to inorganic growth significantly since 2000 (Faheem, 2012) which increased considerably the Group overall revenue from 8.9 billion in 2000 to 108.78 billion USD in 2014 (Tata, 2015 b).

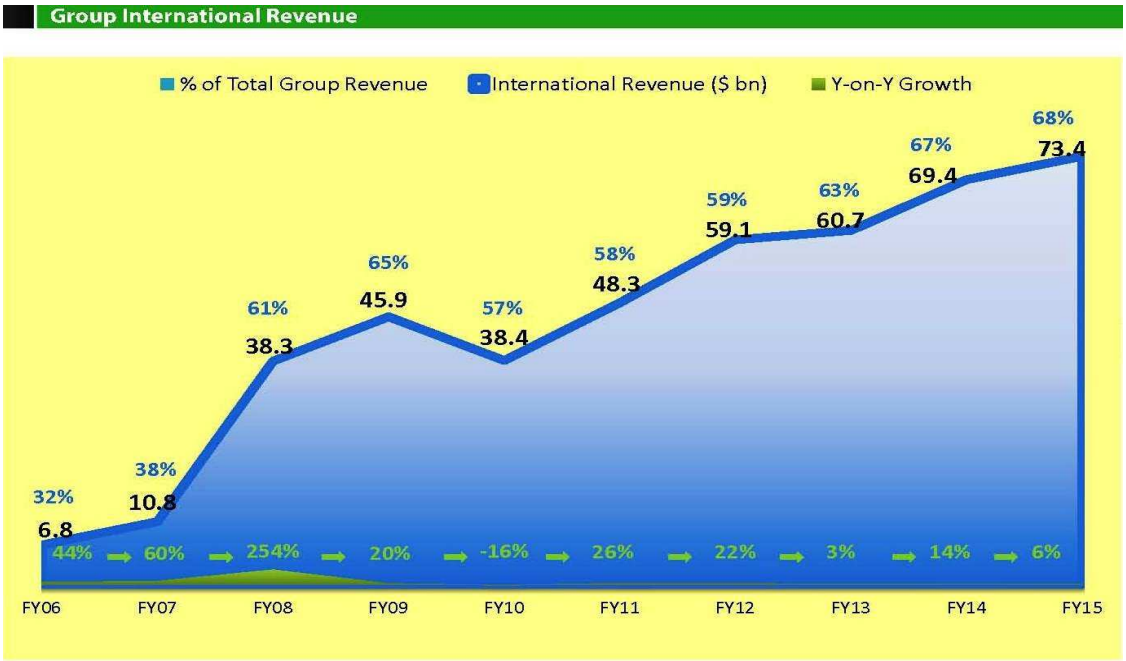

Figure No. 2 Tata Group international revenue (Tata, 2015 b)

As Chatterjee (2007) mentioned that same industry mergers are less risky if the organizational culture and integration handled properly. Tata M&A are considered same industry such as Tata steel acquisition of Corsu steel in 2007, Tata Motor acquisition of JLR in 2008 and Daewoo in 2001 and more (Tata, 2015 c) are good examples of the same industry acquisitions. In the same industry acquisition, all parties know the business and the dynamic of industry which reduces failures (Chatterjee 2007). Multiple industries involvement provides Tata with choices to enter global market broadly in a different business with the same industry.

Regularly the takeover events are disrupted by stock market sharp decline and consequent time of financial recession and M&A usually increases during economic recovery periods (Martynova and Renneboog 2008), but as Tata's list of M&A shows they have increased the number of acquisition during 2007-8 global financial crises. Between 2007 and 2008 they have acquired 18 companies including some of the big names such as JLR and Corus (Tata, 2015 c). During that time analyst has criticized the move (Gribben, 2013) but now according to Philip and Joshi (2014) JLR brought 72% revenue to the group in 2013 which indicates a great success as they took the advantage of businesses reluctance to their own favor and a gamble which paid off (Philip and Joshi, 2014).

M&A helps organizations to transform and expand rapidly, diversify business quickly and enhance market competitiveness (Gao, 2015). Agreements that targets synergy effects containing the strategic competences, exchange of knowledge and technology provide companies exceptional opportunities to understand, as they go beyond the context of their organizational and culture strategies (Gupta and Roos, 2001). Analyst indicated that Tata Motor acquisitions provided them with synergies and intangible resources like new market and better R&D resources, their cooperation with Fiat is a good example of this fact, which provided Tata access to European market via the distribution network of Fiat. Furthermore, global motor connections improved Tata competitiveness worldwide (Faheem 2012).

In Tata Group every operating firm creates their own global strategy depending on the industry nature, available opportunities and the global stage dynamic competitiveness (Tata, 2015 b). For some firms domestic market of India is a priority, for some, international market presence for their products is under focus. Tata Group companies are increasing through acquisitions and joint ventures and expanding through diverse markets and geographies and emerging as an integral part of economies. All of these effective strategies helped Tata to be a group of 100 companies, 610000 employees, and operating in over 100 countries, and a global leader in numerous sectors (Tata, 2015 b).

6. Tata Group Innovation Strategy

For every company, especially a company with that large scale as Tata is, it is essential to focus on creativity and innovations and provide support and direction to individual firms in different industries to remain competitive and have applicable strategies for innovations (Mithas, and Arora 2015). For Tata, innovation strategies are vital as their business is expanding throughout the world (Tata, 2015 e). They are following three approaches to motivate and increase innovation throughout the group industries which are recognition and good communication of inventive ideas, facilities, efforts, and creativities which allow understanding from other businesses, and support for cooperative study and academic partnerships (Mithas, and Arora, 2015). Innovation has got a special concentration in transformational agenda of Tata, which also included in Tata's business model which, helped Tata to transform its revenue from 5.8 billion in 1992 to 103 billion USD in 2004 (Mithas, and Arora 2015).

Grawe, (2009) stated that there are several theories of innovations to understand the way it happens or for its external and internal consequences explanation. Even though Tata has more than 100 years innovation history among the group, recently some systematic processes have undertaken to more actively manage innovations at business level which resulted in the creation of Tata Group Innovation Forum (TGIF) in 2007 to help expand innovation (Mithas, and Arora 2015). TGIF became a body for connecting Tata companies around the world, inspiring innovative ideas, nurturing researches collaboration and acts like an ecosystem among the group for innovation. TGIF arranges building partnerships, learning missions, workshops and events to create an interface among executives, academicians, and innovation experts. They meet every

quarter to analyze improvement and recommend actions to fulfill the gaps in the ecosystem of innovation (Tata, 2015 e). They encourage firms to form the innovative atmosphere, indicate them ways to develop innovative competencies and create innovative groups. TGIF is focusing on four main areas: facilitate innovation, build capacity for innovation, recognize and reward innovation and measure innovation (Mithas and Arora 2015).

Based on Schumpeter perspective view big companies have a greater capacity to innovate as they have larger market power and budget to spend on researches (Grawe, 2009). Tata has allocated a special budget to stimulate new innovative thinking in addition, TGIF invites experts and academicians to share their view with Tata members. Some of the famous names include Dr. James Canton, Clayton Christensen, David Wittenberg, Prof Henry and many more of the key names in this field (Mithas, and Arora 2015).

Based on Tata (2015) presentation, Nano car was one of the surprising innovative products of Tata Motors this car a was one of the world cheapest car which was compact with more passenger space, Tata Swatch water purifier which provides portable water without using electricity, usage of aluminium for car body structure (Aluminium is much lighter than other metals) to minimize the weight of the car which will consequently reduce fuel consumption and improve efficiency and also help the environment with low emission, and silent trucks are among the key recent innovations of the Group (Tata, 2015 b).

7. Tata Group Risk Management Assessment

Inorganic growth is the fastest growing method which involves a great amount of risk, to ensure successes; precautions must be considered during planning and execution (Kuntz, 2014). Research shows that most of the mergers and acquisition are not successful to achieve intended objectives, Schraeder and Dennis (2003) mentioned that around 70-55% of acquisitions and mergers have failed to achieve the expectations. The key challenges for any M&A are integration, demographic, political and organizational cultural challenges (Schraeder and Dennis, 2003). For Tata as mainly an inorganic growth follower, it is necessary to consider all these challenges as these complications have impacts on the company performances.

Every company in the Group has an Enterprise Risk Management (ERM) framework which focuses on risks and opportunities in a particular industry. In order to be competitive, the framework helps the company to take certain risks and alleviate additional risks to push toward sustainability, opportunities and risks identification and proactively addressing them protect the value of shareholders greatly (Tata Steel, 2015).

Some analyst indicated that although Tata's revenue has improved due to inorganic growth but it also increases the risk of failure due to weak integration and portfolio management. As the group is looking toward more acquisition around the world the challenge of integration needs strong attention (Mukherji et al 2009). So far Tata has dealt with it expertly, in most cases, Tata

has left the procedures intact as Jaguar design director Ian Callum 2008 summarized it in his speech "We have shown Tata our new model lines and the planned product cycle. The two national cultures appear to fit together very well and Tata is being very respectful about what we are doing." (Riley, 2012).

Most of the time buying a business is costing a huge amount of money, the organization needs to make sure they have the skills and ability to profitably run the business (IMI 2015). Acquisition of a firm is not just procuring stock, building, and employees but it also includes intangible resources like liabilities, reputation, goodwill and intellectual property (IMI 2015). There is always a high risk of losing money and reputation in acquisition but as Tata growth indicates so far in most cases they have dealt well with it. Nevertheless, ideally matched M&A can still not be successful if firm cultures don't blend efficiently as transactions often fail not because of poor strategy, but by bad integration and implementation either on the back-end operations or on the front end in integrating brands (Kuntz, 2014).

As Tata M&A records indicate, the majority of them are overseas. And based on Koerniadi et al, (2015) international M&As include higher complexity than national M&A deals, including culture, economic and political environments, accounting, and international relationships. Furthermore, M&A certainly have an influence on the risk profile of companies even it contains the probability of bankruptcy (Koerniadi et al, 2015). Tata needs to analyze and consider all these aspects in their deals ahead.

Furthermore, the personal objective of managers have a high influence on M&A, in some extent managers greediness and herding rises during takeover surges which in most cases leads to bad acquisition, (Martynova and Renneboog 2008). And experts observe Tata's current M&A as desperate, though for the time being mostly successful but it is not risk-free and the group executive must give it more attention (Mukherji et al, 2009).

8. Conclusion

Global presence in the diverse industries and access to advanced technology and key markets are signs of more success and profitability for Tata Group going forward. They need to focus more on integration among the companies as it is challenging managing a vast group of 100 companies.

The international market presence and overall revenue improvement from $ 6 billion in 1996 to $ 108.78 in 2015 all indicate huge progress and bright future for Tata Group. In order to make sure the successes continue the group needs to focus on companies' management both domestically and globally, and as well as innovation, quality, and price.

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10.Appendices

Tonnage is expressed in million tons (Mt).

RANK IN 2014	COMPANY	TONNAGE
1	ArcelorMittal	98.088
2	Nippon Steel and Sumitomo Metal Corporation	49.300
3	Hebei Steel Group	47.094
4	Baosteel Group	43.347
5	POSCO	41.428
6	Shagang Group	35.332
7	Ansteel Group	34.348
8	Wuhan Steel Group	33.053
9	JFE Steel Corporation	31.406
10	Shougang Group	30.777
11	Tata Steel Group	26.202

Global steel companies ranking (World Steel Association, 2014)

Year	Tata Com	Acquired Company	Country	Stake Acquired
2015				
March	Tata Power	Itezhi Tezhi Power Corporation (ITPC)	Zambia	50 per cent
February	Tata Business Support Services	e-Nxt Financials (e-Nxt)	India	
2014				
December	Tata Power	Energy Projects Limited (IEPL)	India	100 per cent
May	Tata Global Beverages	Earth Rules (acquired by Bronski Eleven, a TGB subsidiary)	Australia	100 per cent
2013				
July	TCS	Alti SA	France	100 per cent (wholly-owned)
2011				
April	Tata Chemicals	Olam International, Republic of Gabon	Republic of Gabon	25.1 per cent
August	Tata Chemicals	EPM Mining Ventures	Canada	30.6 per cent
2010				
January	Tata Communications	BT Group's (BT) Mosaic business	UK	100 per cent
April	TRF	Hewitt Robins International	UK	
December	Rallis India (through Tata Chemicals)	Metahelix Life Sciences	India	53.5 per cent
	Tata Chemicals	British Salt	UK	100 per cent (wholly-owned)
	Tata International	Bachi Shoes India	India	76 per cent
	Tata International	Euro Shoe Components	India	76 per cent

Tata Group mergers and acquisitions recent list, (Tata, 2015 c)